

SAQUIB AKHTAR

Subject Matter Expert: Linux, Cluster & Virtualization || Zabbix Guru || BASH+Ansible Scripter || GNU || Data Center || Identity Management Solutions

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🌐 <https://wiki.debian.org/SaquibAkhtar> 📍 Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh

SYNOPSIS

9+ Years. of Exp. in the field of Systems Administration with deployment, configuration and monitoring of Linux Servers, Clusters, Virtualization, Middleware, Mail Servers, LDAP/AD/IPA, Zabbix monitoring & Cloud hosting: AWS, Linode, Digital Ocean, GoDaddy.

Linux Architect with experience in maintenance of Linux VM's over VMWare virtualization AWS Cloud Services. Veritas Info Scale Availability Cluster v6.1.1 and v7.4.1 consisting of RHEL 6.10 family nodes. Expert in RHEL Pacemaker & CMAN Cluster. Deployed 2 Node HPE Service Guard Cluster. I have deployed Uyuni Spacewalk, Foreman, RHEL Satellite, IPA LDAP, and Squid proxy servers. I also perform total infra monitoring via Zabbix Monitoring Tool including Cluster and log file monitoring. Apart from this, I manage Linux File Servers like NFS Server, SAMBA Servers (joined to AD Domain), FTP Servers. Also, I manage Middleware administration servers: Apache, Tomcat, and Nginx.

Experienced in harnessing the robust feature set of Nokia Cloudband infrastructure to drive optimal telecom cloud performance. Proficient in scalability, service orchestration, VNF management, multi-tenancy, high availability, integrated security, and resource optimization. Well-versed in OpenStack integration and NFV compatibility, ensuring the delivery of high-quality telecom services in a dynamic and secure cloud environment.

EXPERIENCE

12/2024 - Present

Lucknow, India

- **Linux IDM T3 Specialist (Lead L3)**
Nokia Solutions & Networks India Pvt. Ltd.

Identity & Access Management Team (IAM)

- Linux Identity Management Suite: 389 DS, LDAP, IPA, AD
- Management of Multiple Master-Slave IPA Servers, NIS Servers
- Tuning & Troubleshooting of IPA Servers
- Zabbix Monitoring Tool integration & management

04/2023 - 12/2024

Lucknow, India

- **Technical Care Specialist - Telco Cloudband**
Nokia Solutions & Networks India Pvt. Ltd.

Global Customer Support L3 Team

- Telco CBIS, NCS Infrastructure
Supporting: OpenStack, RHEV, Docker, Kubernetes, Zabbix, Apache, Nginx, VA Scanning
HPE BladeSystem c7000, ProLiant DL 360/DL 380 Gen 10/ Gen 10 Plus, Dell R640 R740, Nokia AirFrame Hardware
- Multiple Global customer support for Cloudband Infrastructure on OpenStack with Dell, AirFrame & HPE Hardwares along with external SAN storage.

04/2021 - 04/2023

Lucknow, India

- **Senior Specialist (Linux Architect)**
HCL Technologies Ltd

Project: UPM, Finland

- Managing & administration of Linux OS family: RHEL (5,6,7,8), Ubuntu 16,18,20, SLES 12,15, Oracle Linux 6,7, OpenSuse 15 Leap.
- Deployed & managing 4 x 2 Node Service Guard (HPE SGLX) cluster on SLES 12 & SLES 15 with multiple shared LVM's and services hosted
- Deployed & managing Graylog Server with Elasticsearch, MongoDB & Apache Reverse Proxy with SSO.
- Deployed & managing Uyuni SuseManager Spacewalk server for centralized package management & patching of all Linux OS family
- Managing Linux based FTP, NFS, NTP Servers
- Implementation of network teaming / bonding as per policy required
- Migrated RHEL 6 based Apache SSO to RHEL 7 with OTM weblogic application. Reconfigured Apache SSO under new requirements with Read/Write rules
- Implementation of AD authentication of all Linux OS family using SSSD & Centrify plugin for centralized user management. Management of SAMBA AD shares with advance parameters
- Creating new systemd files for the custom user services
- Linux OS hardening with as per organization policies
- Managing HPE physical servers: c7000 blade enclosures, HPE Gen7,8,9,10 Rack Servers, 480 Gen 10 Synergy chassis, Dell R460, R640, R740 rack servers
- Implemented Ansible Playbook on Ansible Tower for Log4J Vulnerability scanning for all Linux Systems. Bash script for installation of custom RPMs and upgrade of packages.

- **Monitoring & Tools**

- Implementation of Zabbix Server with HA & Zabbix Proxy with advance performance tuning.
- Implementation of custom application monitoring with Zabbix with customized templates & Macros.
- Implemented new template for Log File monitoring, Cluster monitoring.

- **Virtualization**

- Creating VM's on VM ware infra with ESXi 6.5,7 with RDM's (Virtual & Pass-through/physical) as per requirements.
- Performing LIVE VMOTION as required. Managing the UPLINKS of ESXi blades.
- Upgrading of VM Ware tools on all Linux OS family.
- Create new datastore from LUN as per provisioning policy.
- Troubleshooting of all Linux VM's in case of ESXi not responding, VM unreachable, Datastore disconnection, Network uplink failure at ESXi nodes.

EXPERIENCE

08/2019 - 04/2021

New Delhi, India

Roles & Responsibilities

- Working as Linux L3 & Architect where handling Critical INC & escalated cases.
- Maintain proper functioning of all Linux VMs and cluster services in an organization and ensure 99% uptime of server infrastructure of an organization.
- Ensure the security of the Linux VM's by hardening and security scanning from time to time. To ensure reliable functioning of OS, time to time upgrades and security patching of the OS.
- Monitor the system health and all parameters to ensure proper functioning and minimum downtime of systems for any issue if applicable.
- Checking the server and appliances logs for any unusual activity or any type of malfunctioning.
- Providing complete root cause analysis of any downtime that occurred with future remedy to prevent such further issue.
- Maintaining complete inventory of all Linux and related infrastructure.
- Follow site-specific escalation matrix - Timely escalations to the next level.
- Maintain the asset inventory of all Linux VM's, mount points, Applications details.
- RCA has to carry out for each of the P1/P2 incidents and track till closure.
- Ensure Asset Management tracked and updated regularly.
- Ensure Patch Management, Endpoint Security installation on Linux Servers and definition updates.

Project Engineer (Team Lead: Linux)

Wipro Limited

Project: HT Media Limited, New Delhi

- Monitor and manage the complete Linux infrastructure at Sify Datacenter and AWS Cloud infrastructure.
 - Configuration and installation of Red Hat based machines on the VM Ware ESXi 6.0 from hardened Linux templates or from the ISO as required
 - Managing the Veritas Cluster infrastructure with 8 nodes cluster set-up on VCS version 6.1 and Red Hat Enterprise Linux 6.6 server having services: Tomcat, NFS, Database, Alert and Search
 - Configuration and management of 2 Node RHEL Pacemaker MariaDB Cluster with Master-Slave replication
 - Configuring SAMBA (with SSSD & winbind AD authentication) and NFS shares on the RHEL 6 & 7 for the internal application use
 - Configuration of YUM HTTP Server for RHEL Machines & Spacewalk Server for centralized patching of CentOS based Servers
 - Configuration and management of Squid Proxy Server
 - Configuration of FTP server on RHEL 6 & 7 for the users. LVM and disk management with file systems like: ext3, ext4, xfs and btrfs on RHEL/CentOS and Ubuntu machines.
 - Configuration of LDAP based FTP Server for multiple users & RedHat IPA Server for centralized authentication & policy management for RedHat & CentOS 6,7 and Ubuntu 14.04, 16.04, 18.04 VMs.
 - Deployment and backup of all website virtual hosting via Nginx and Apache servers.
 - Advanced Linux OS troubleshooting and configuration involving kernel tuning and emergency system recovery.
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- Deployment of Zabbix Server for 24x7 monitoring of all servers, network devices, storage, firewall and services via SNMP alerts and Zabbix Agents.
 - Cluster command-based monitoring via Zabbix.
 - Installation of Zabbix agents via Ansible server across all the Red Hat & CentOS distributions for OS as well as customized services monitoring and log file monitoring.
 - E-mail based alert messaging to provide alerts to assigned authority.
 - Generation of Problems Reports and analyzing them to generate overall downtime and issues report.
 - Monitoring of all the Linux Servers via Cockpit utility from central monitoring server.
 - Alarm triggering for the alerts via ICINGA monitoring tool for all the AWS Cloud infrastructure.
 - Cloud Watch tool analysis for making daily monitoring reports and uptime/downtime matrix.

EXPERIENCE

10/2017 - 07/2019

Lucknow, India

Senior Linux System Administrator

Harivansh Consulting OPC Pvt. Ltd. (Power-Guru)

Project: Medhaj Techno Concept Pvt. Ltd. Lucknow, Private School & Institutions.

• SERVER ADMINISTRATION

☑Configured

- and managing HP ProLiant servers with iLO 4 utility.
- ☑Configured and managing Dell Rack and Tower servers with iDRAC 8 enterprise utility.
- ☑Applying various drivers and firmware updates to various servers.
- ☑Configured RAID, NIC teaming, KVM based RHEV virtualization, iSCSI in HP and Dell servers.
- ☑Installation of CentOS 6 & 7, RHEL 6 & 7 & Ubuntu 16.04, 18.04 on HP and Dell servers via remote access utility.
- ☑Installed and Configured IBM System x3200 with Windows Server 2008R2.
- ☑Configured Windows Server 2008R2, 2012R2 VM with MS SQL 2008R2 via RHEV.
- ☑Configured CentOS 7 VM with Webmin with Virtualmin panel for hosting and development area.
- ☑Configured and managing in premise IRedMail Server in CentOS 7.5 with auto-backup for 2000+ users with PostgreSQL Database Server, NGINX Web Server, Round Cube Web-Mail with high performance tuning.
- ☑Configured Spam Assassin, ClamAV, SPF, DKIM, greylisting, whitelisting, blacklisting services for controlling e-mail spamming and e-mail scanning.
- ☑Configured SAMBA 4 Active Directory Server, OpenLDAP Server, IPA Server & 389 Directory Server on CentOS 7 for managing Windows & Ubuntu systems via Domain Controllers.
- ☑Configured VNC server on CentOS and Ubuntu for remote access of server.
- ☑Configured PostgreSQL & MySQL Database Server with high availability with performance tuning.
- ☑Managing Linux (Cent-OS and Ubuntu), Windows servers on Linode & Digital Ocean cloud.
- ☑Managing Cloud based Load Balancers on Linode & Digital Ocean.
- ☑Configured backup policy for all the laptops/desktops (Windows, Ubuntu and MAC OS X) to send automatic archival backup to the local backup server at the scheduled time.
- ☑Managing Windows Systems with group policy control mechanisms.

• STORAGE ADMINISTRATION

☑Deployment

- of Netgear and WD NAS storage with iSCSI-based block storage with CHAP based authentication.
- ☑SAMBA, NFS, FTP, TFTP based sharing mechanisms for providing shares to servers and users.
- ☑Configuration of E-mail based alerts for providing all hardware and storage alerts.
- ☑Working with Free NAS based open source-based storage OS with multiple file systems using iSCSI protocol.

• NETWORK ADMINISTRATION

☑Configured

- and managing Cyberoam CR-50ing, 100ing, Sophos XG210 series firewall with various policies, user authentication, DHCP MAC binding, LAN & DMZ zone, WAN link load balancing, WAF rules, Mail configuration with SNMP monitoring.
- ☑SSL VPN configuration with for accessing internal servers, network devices, storage from any WAN network.
- ☑IP-Sec VPN between two different sites for providing dedicated connectivity between the servers.
- ☑Migration of firewall from Cyberoam to Sophos XG series.
- ☑Deployed Ubiquiti edge router ERLite 3 for Load Balance, QoS and for FTP file transfer and backup.
- ☑Configuration of UNMS based monitoring system for Ubiquiti Edge router monitoring and firmware upgrade.

01/2013 - 09/2017

Lucknow, India

System Administrator

Freelance support with domestic organizations & local IT infrastructure

System Administration under Linux, and Windows, Network Administration, Zabbix Monitoring, Website hosting, Mail Services, On-premise physical deployment and troubleshooting like Proxy Server, SAMBA/NFS Server, FTP Server, Windows AD, NMS, EPABX & DIAL-UP Connections, WAN DSL, ADSL & VDSL Modem/Router deployment, DVR/NVR CCTV Management, Linux CUPS & Windows Print Server Management, PXE Boot Server Management.

RHCE, RHCVA, CCNA R&S

• Technical Certifications

- Red Hat Accredited Professional in Red Hat Delivery Specialist: Virtualization bearing Identifier: 40333147
- Red Hat Certified Engineer on RHEL 7, Certification ID: 180-085-201
- Cisco Certified Network Associate Routing & Switching V200-125, Cisco ID: CSC013160718 & Certification ID: 428364169401FLYJ
- System Administration and IT Infrastructure Services, Google IT support specialization Certification ID: 86KS6AS4E8T5
- Completed Linux Networking and Administration (LFS211) training by Linux Foundation
- Training on Linux High Availability Clustering, Linux Security & Hardening, Linux Advanced Diagnostics & Troubleshooting
- Training on Veritas Info Scale Linux Administration for Veritas Cluster Server v7.3
- Fellow at SANOG 2022 (South Asia Network Operator Group) at Kathmandu, Nepal & completed Network & Linux Automation Workshop
- Fellow at inSIG 2018 (Indian School of Internet Governance 2018) at India International Center, New Delhi from 13 October, 2018 to 15 October, 2018
- Completed Spoken Tutorial Project on Linux IIT Bombay, funded by National Mission on Education through ICT, MHRD, Govt. of India
- Presented paper on ENTERPRISE NETWORK DESIGN in International Information Security Conference on 13 January, 2017 at Amity Institute of Information Technology, Lucknow

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS



EMPOWERED

Issued by Nokia, July 2024 for Exceptional support for CBIS product issues (Nokia Cloudband).



BU Awards 2022

Issued by HCL Tech, Sep 2022, OUTSTANDING DOMAIN WORK & SOLUTIONS



BU Awards - 2020 - MARCH

Issued by Wipro Limited, Mar 2020, High Customer Satisfaction



Inspiring Performance [Achievement Orientation] - 2019 - DECEMBER

Issued by Wipro Limited, Dec 2019, Achievement Orientation



Certificate of Appreciation

Issued by HCL Tech, Jan 2022, CUSTOMER SATISFACTION



SANOG 38 Fellowship

Issued SANOG Group, July 2022

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS



SANOG 34 Fellowship

Issued by South Asian Network Operators Group, Jul 2019



INSIG 2018

Issued by Internet Society, Oct 2018, Fellow at inSIG 2018 (Indian School of Internet Governance 2018) New Delhi from 13 October, 2018 to 15 October, 2018

EDUCATION

2013 - 2017

Lucknow

- **B. Tech CSE**
Dr. APJ Abdul Kalam Technical University (AKTU formerly UPTU) Shri Ramswaroop Memorial College of Engineering & Management
 - 76.3% 1st Division (Hons.)

2013

Lucknow

- **Intermediate**
CBSE, Red Rose Public School, Lucknow
78.2% **4.0 / 4.0**

2011

Lucknow

- **High School**
CBSE, Red Rose Public School, Lucknow
83.6% **4.0 / 4.0**

LANGUAGES

English
Native



Hindi
Native



SKILLS

LINUX	AWS	Apache/Tomcat/Nginx	Bash & Ansible Script	Cisco	Linux Clustering	Veritas & HPE SGLX Cluster
Mail Server	Security Hardening	Performance Tuning	Firmware Management	Virtualization	Information security	
LDAP/IPA/AD	Zabbix	Architecture Designing	Linux Identity management team	IPA/LDAP Server	389 DS	
OpenStack	Nessus Vulnerability Scanning	RHEV				

PERSONAL PROFILE

Father's Name	Rashid Akhtar
Mother's Name	Shahina Akhtar
Residential Address	Flat No. 605, Crystal Link Apartment, Shaheed Path, near AWHO Colony, Lucknow – 226009, Uttar Pradesh
Languages	English & Hindi
AADHAR Number	361646201223
PAN CARD	BKKPA5631G
Passport Number	V0215256